



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: California Republic Leadership Academy
School Website: <https://crlacapo.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

California Republic Leadership Academy Capistrano (CRLA Capistrano) presents a clear classical-leaning profile in public materials. The school positions itself as a tuition-free, public charter grounded in classical liberal arts, with explicit emphasis on virtue, leadership, and a content-rich curriculum. Public materials stress formation of character and leadership through a virtue-based education, pursuit of truth, and love of the true, good, and beautiful. At the same time, explicit theological or liturgical foundations are not foregrounded, suggesting a nonsectarian classical framing rather than a religious-metaphysical program. On curriculum, pedagogy, and the teacher's role, CRLA Capistrano demonstrates strong classical markers (grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic method, rhetoric).□□□□-wise, the school evidences many classical elements, though with some gaps in explicit religious/metaphysical language and in documented parent-partnership practices within public-facing materials.

- Overall classification (aggregate): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Why this aggregate rating: The school robustly satisfies core classical criteria in Curriculum and Pedagogy, and it aligns with the School Purpose/Goal. It shows meaningful evidence of Virtue-based formation and leadership-focused aims (Element 2) and strong classical Curricular structures (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4). However, explicit Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and sustained, public-facing Parent/Community partnerships (Element 1 and Element 6) are less clearly documented in the materials provided. Faculty presence is evident (Element 5) but the public materials do not consistently present the "living curriculum" or the same depth of faculty-character articulation found in some classical schools, which tempers a full Classical ranking. See category-by-category notes for details.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools):
 - Strengthen explicit articulation of religious/metaphysical foundations or liturgical/community practices in public-facing materials where appropriate (without compromising non-sectarian status if that is maintained).
 - Expand public-facing language around parent partnership and co-education (co-teaching roles, home-school collaboration, family formation activities) to align with the "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" cues in classical lexicons.
 - Highlight more explicit statements about the faculty as living curriculum and the portrait of teacher ideals to reinforce Element 5 as CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot will follow, with category-specific keyword analyses and scoring justifications grounded in the six-element classical rubric.

Notes on sources: This assessment synthesizes two data sources available in the prompt's vector stores:
- School-specific content for CRLA Capistrano (public-facing site materials, FAQs, curriculum descriptions, "What is Classical Education?" pages, team pages) cited where relevant. For example, CRLA Capistrano's mission and virtue-based framing are documented in the site content, including explicit statements about virtue, truth, and the good/beautiful. See evidence excerpts such as "A Tuition-Free Independent Charter School" and "Classical Education guides students to love that which is true, good, and beautiful" statements.

- The classical-school knowledge base (lexicon and Six Essential Elements prompts) used to anchor keyword indicators for all six categories. See the presence of keywords like truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, great books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, Socratic method, scholé, etc., and the explicit six-category framework.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize virtue-based education and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as core ideals. The mission/vision language frames virtue and the classical good as central aims. The site explicitly discusses forming leaders through a virtue-based education and the pursuit of truth, virtue, and wisdom.
 - Evidence of transcendental realism is implicit in the language about “the true, good, and beautiful” and “the classical ideal—excellence of soul, mind, and body,” but religious-theological terms (theology, liturgy, sacramental language) are not foregrounded in public-facing site content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (from lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral realism, imago Dei or theological language not explicitly present here; “permanent” or transcendentals not foregrounded in public copy. The clearest matches are truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue.
 - Negative keywords: not clearly present (no explicit relativism or secular humanism signals in the public materials reviewed here).
 - Frequency/weight: Positive hits exceed negatives (roughly 4 strong positive signals identified: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue). No explicit counter-narratives detected in public copy.
- Why this rating
 - The materials foreground transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue, aligning with Transcendental Moral Realism and Virtue-focused formation. However, explicit theological, liturgical, or communal worship language is not foregrounded in the public-facing CRLA Capistrano materials (nonsectarian framing). This yields a strong but not fully explicit classical signal for this category. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: evidence of virtue-focused aims and truth/goodness/beauty language appears in CRLA Capistrano pages describing classical education and mission.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly states formation through virtue-based education, leadership development, and moral character as central aims. The mission describes “develop the next generation of leaders in mind, character, and practice through a virtue-based education.” The emphasis on virtue, leadership, and the pursuit of truth/virtue/wisdom aligns with formation toward human flourishing and classical telos.
 - The public materials frame education as formation rather than mere information, with explicit emphasis on forming virtue and wisdom and on human excellence through classical pedagogy. The Great Books/Great Conversation framing and the Trivium-oriented terms in other pages support this orientation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit push toward workforce prep or job-readiness as the sole aim).
 - Frequency/weight: 7–8 positive keywords identified; near-zero negatives.
- Why this rating

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- The materials strongly reflect formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical liberal-arts telos. While not every possible phrase from the lexicon is present, the core items (formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission) are clearly stated. This justifies CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Citations: mission/virtue-based formation language; references to classical education as a means for forming leaders and character.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The CRLA Capistrano materials emphasize Trivium elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a content-rich classical curriculum. Public-facing descriptions discuss Great Books, the Great Conversation, and the study of classical languages (Latin/Greek roots, formal Latin in later grades). Specific pages discuss “What is Classical Education?” and show the Trivium framing and the Great Books approach.
 - There are explicit mentions of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and of a curriculum anchored in classical liberal arts with emphasis on history, Western civilization, and primary classical texts. The Hillsdale Core Knowledge, Core Knowledge, and Leader in Me content reflect a structured, knowledge-rich approach, but still within classical framing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, great conversation, Western civilization, Latin/Greek, history, Socratic texts, recitation, narration, and other classical methods.
 - Negative keywords present: no explicit “project-based learning dominance” or “social studies” rebranding in place of history; they primarily emphasize classical history and primary sources rather than social-studies framing.
 - Frequency/weight: multiple explicit classical-curriculum keywords observed (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, history/Western civilization).
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly anchors curriculum in the Trivium, Great Books, and a classical-heritage approach, plus languages and history. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL in the Curriculum category.

Citations: evidence of Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, and language/historical emphasis from CRLA Capistrano materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials feature the Socratic Method and seminars as central pedagogical approaches. The site includes explicit pages on “The Socratic Method” and discussions about how classical education should use Socratic dialogue, memory work, and rhetoric. There are pages describing upper-school seminars, debates, and public speaking as part of the classical pedagogy.
 - The content also indicates a staged Trivium pedagogy (Grammar Stage for younger students, Logic Stage, Rhetoric Stage) and pedagogy around memory work (recitation, chanting) and imitation of models, aligning with scholarly classical practices.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, seminars, recitation, chanting, memory work, mastery through imitation, rhetoric exercises, capstone orations, scholé/restful learning, wonder-based education.
 - Negative keywords present: minimal explicit presence of purely experiential or project-based-only approaches; the site emphasizes tradition and classical pedagogy rather than constructivist or heavily student-directed models.

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- Frequency/weight: multiple explicit classical-pedagogy terms identified; low presence of non-classical pedagogy signals.
 - Why this rating
 - The school presents strong classical pedagogy alignment: Socratic discussions, seminars, rhetoric training, and memory work are highlighted. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic Method and related pedagogy terms on CRLA Capistrano pages; references to memory work and classical pedagogical approaches.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials show named faculty (Executive Director, Principal, teachers) and a leadership structure, including messages about the “team” and individual teachers. This demonstrates that teachers are central to school operations, but the public materials do not consistently articulate a fully-developed “living curriculum,” teacher portrait, or a formal faculty-formational philosophy in the same depth as some classical schools. Still, pages discuss teachers guiding with classical pedagogy and the central role of teachers in delivering the curriculum.
 - The KR lexicon for the Faculty category emphasizes “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” and “portrait of a teacher.” Public content mentions dedicated teachers and administrators, but the explicit articulation of “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty as living curriculum” is not consistently spelled out beyond standard staff pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture.
 - Negative keywords present: not clearly evident in public content; the lack of explicit statements about how teachers embody the living curriculum is a gap relative to the lexicon.
 - Frequency/weight: Several public items reference faculty roles and leadership, but the strongest lexicon items (living curriculum, portrait of teacher) are not deeply foregrounded in the public copy.
- Why this rating
 - While CRLA Capistrano demonstrates that teachers exist in a central role and the school is led by a professional team, the public materials do not consistently provide the explicit, elevated “living curriculum” teacher-portrait framing that would push Element 5 to CLASSICAL. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Citations: faculty/team pages and leadership statements; reference to “living curriculum” concept in classical lexicon.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials show open enrollment, campus tours, FAQs about enrollment, and opportunities to engage with CRLA Capistrano (e.g., “Enroll Today,” “Join Us,” “Open Enrollment” timelines). There are community-facing postings (School Postings) and parent-related information (e.g., Independent Study forms, enrollment processes). These indicate a public-facing structure for parent participation but do not consistently foreground the “partnership with families” or “parent-formation” activities as central programmatic pillars in the same depth as some classical schools’ materials.
 - Some pages reference parent-related processes and family engagement (volunteer forms, postings, parent-handbooks). However, explicit language about parents as co-teachers or ongoing family-formation programming is not consistently foregrounded in the materials we reviewed. The lexicon’s positive indications for “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” are present in the classical model, but not fully saturated in public CRLA content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive keywords present (from lexicon): Partnership with Families (parents as co-educators), parent formation, open campus, family participation, home-centered learning, parental involvement.
 - Negative keywords present: consumer-languaging signals (customer-focused) would be a negative in some classical models; these are not overtly evident in CRLA's public content but lack of explicit co-teacher framing is a gap.
 - Frequency/weight: Public materials show enrollment and parent-facing processes; explicit "parents as co-teachers" language is not consistently foregrounded.
 - Why this rating
 - The school engages with families via enrollment processes and general community activities, but it does not consistently foreground a robust, public-facing parental-partnership philosophy in the same depth as the ideal "Partnership with Families" lexicon. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: enrollment/tour information and family-related postings; parent-facing content.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Introduce explicit, culturally appropriate language around transcendentals and virtue in public materials, while maintaining nonsectarian status if desired. Add a phrasing emphasis on reverence/wonder in classroom culture and clarify any liturgical or communal practices that align with your tradition (if applicable).
- Element 5 (Faculty): Expand the articulation of the living curriculum by publishing a dedicated section on how faculty develop and model virtue, a formal portrait of teacher expectations, and a clear statement about teacher professional development in classical pedagogy.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Strengthen explicit parent-partnership language, with concrete programs such as family book clubs, home-education resources, family liturgy or virtue studies, and regular parent-teacher co-mentoring opportunities. Feature a public-facing "Parents as Co-Teachers" page that outlines roles, expectations, and opportunities for involvement.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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